

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 2
 ♥ K Q 10
 ♦ A J 7 5 3
 ♣ Q 8 7

♠ 7
 ♥ A J 9 8 7 5 4
 ♦ 8
 ♣ K 10 6 3

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♠ Q J 10
 ♥ 3
 ♦ K 10 9 6 2
 ♣ A J 9 4

♠ A K 9 8 6 5 3
 ♥ 6 2
 ♦ Q 4
 ♣ 5 2

West	North	East	South
	3♥		

All Pass

3♥ by North

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1/2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6/7

The ♠ lead is about the best thing that could have happened to you. You win with dummy's ♠A and play ♠K, discarding your ♦. You then lead a small ♣, covering anything West plays. You'd like to ruff a ♣ if you can, but if they play trumps to stop you then you'd like the trump play to come from East. East leads the ♥3, West plays the ♥K, and you win with the ♥A. You play a small ♣. If the defender who wins the ♣ doesn't play another trump then you can ruff your third ♣ in dummy. If the defender **DOES** play a trump, then you lose only one trump trick. You end up going down 1, which is pretty good.

Some contracts are impossible. So you just play to keep the damage as low as possible.

You really really want to say 3♠. Here are three good reasons you shouldn't.

You have 9 ♥s between you. You may have only 7 ♠s. If you bid 3♠ partner may bid again. You haven't been doubled.

South would play 3♥.

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North plays 3♥. East leads the ♠Q.

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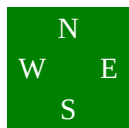
It turns out there was a fourth reason not to bid 3♠ - the opponents might lead the suit.

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 6 5 3
♥ J 10 9 6 4
♦ A 6
♣ 9 8

♠ A 8 2
♥ K Q 5
♦ Q J 7 3
♣ Q 6 4



♠ K 7 4
♥ 8 7 2
♦ K 8 2
♣ J 10 7 5

♠ Q J 10
♥ A 3
♦ 10 9 5 4
♣ A K 3 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

While this is a possible Plan, there is a far better one.

Rather than chance the ♠ finesse, you should immediately start establishing your ♦s. This has the advantage of not giving the defense any **NEW** winners - they were always going to get their two high ♦s. So win the ♥A and play the ♦10. Somebody will take this and probably continue with a ♥. Take the ♥Q and play the ♦Q. Somebody will take this and probably continue with a ♥. Take the ♥K and then the rest of your winners. Maybe the ♣s will split 3-3 and give you an overtrick. And if you have assured the contract you MIGHT even try the ♠ finesse.

If you had taken an early ♠ finesse you would have gone down.

East would have won and played a ♥, removing your second stopper. When ♣s did not split 3-3 you would have been forced to try a ♦. East would win his ♦K and drive out the last ♥ stopper. Then West would be able to take the ♦A plus his established ♥s.

You have three reasonable choices. You could bid 2♣, you could jump to 3♦, or you could jump to 2NT.

While all are reasonable, the jump to 2NT stands out as the most constructive by far. Partner bids 3NT and you pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥J.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥J.

Winner count: ♠ 1 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

If West has the ♠K then a finesse will gain you the two winners you need. However, if East has the ♠K then the finesse will gain you just one winner and you will be hoping for a 3-3 ♣ split for the other.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 4
♥ 7 6 5 2
♦ Q 7 6 4
♣ A J 9

♠ A K 6 2
♥ K Q J 10 9
♦ A J
♣ 6 5



♠ Q J 10 5 3
♥ 4
♦ K 10 8 3
♣ K 10 2

♠ 8 7
♥ A 8 3
♦ 9 5 2
♣ Q 8 7 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North

out but cannot over-ruff. Return to your hand with the ♦ A and ruff your last ♠ with dummy's ♥ A. Return to your hand with a trump. You will lose three minor suit cards and nothing else.

Some would go down on this hand when they ruffed the first ♠ with dummy's ♥ 3 and West over-ruffed. It is pretty clear that you should ruff with one of the higher cards, but sometimes the thought comes too late.

With 19 points and a 5-card ♥ suit you open 1♥.

Partner raises you to 2♥.

Partner's bid shows 6-10 points. If he has 6 it might be close, but otherwise you should have a game. You bid 4♥.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠ Q.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠ Q.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 5

The three minor suit losers cannot be avoided, but the two ♠ losers can be ruffed in dummy. A small amount of caution is in order. Win the ♠ K and play the ♠ A. Ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥ 8. West shows the ♠ A. Ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥ A. Return to your hand with a trump. You will lose three minor suit cards and nothing else.